



some boards will get away by accommodating visiting teams in places no better than college hostels. If the ICC does set up a fund, then that's a big step forward. However, determining the playing fees would be best left to the discretion of individual boards. Standards of living vary from country to country, so having one fixed fee may not be such a good idea.

In all probability, Jay Shah will be the next ICC president. Just as he has done for Indian cricket, both men and women, players worldwide will benefit. When Greg Barclay announced his decision not to go for a third term, which he was entitled to, there were reports in the media of the Old Powers that Barclay's decision had been forced by Shah.

Only when the perennial cribbers were questioned about what the representatives of their Old Powers were doing did it suddenly occur to them that if indeed Barclay was forced to not seek a third term, then what were their own representatives at the ICC doing at the meeting? Where were their voices of objection?

Right step: The Test match fund, which is expected to be in the region of US \$15 million, is understood to have the backing of BCCI secretary Jay Shah and ECB chair Richard Thompson.

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And if there were none, then they were as culpable as the one they were unnecessarily pointing a finger at. It's called the *Tall poppy syndrome* as well as the realisation that they don't run the international game anymore.

The way Indian cricket has shaped up over the years is also a tribute to the BCCI and its administration. The kind of cricket that the teams, both men and women, have been playing is another huge reason why the sport is flourishing in India.

If the team was not winning, the sponsors would stay away. Terrific teamwork from both the players and the administrators explains why Indian cricket is in such a healthy state. May it always remain so.



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